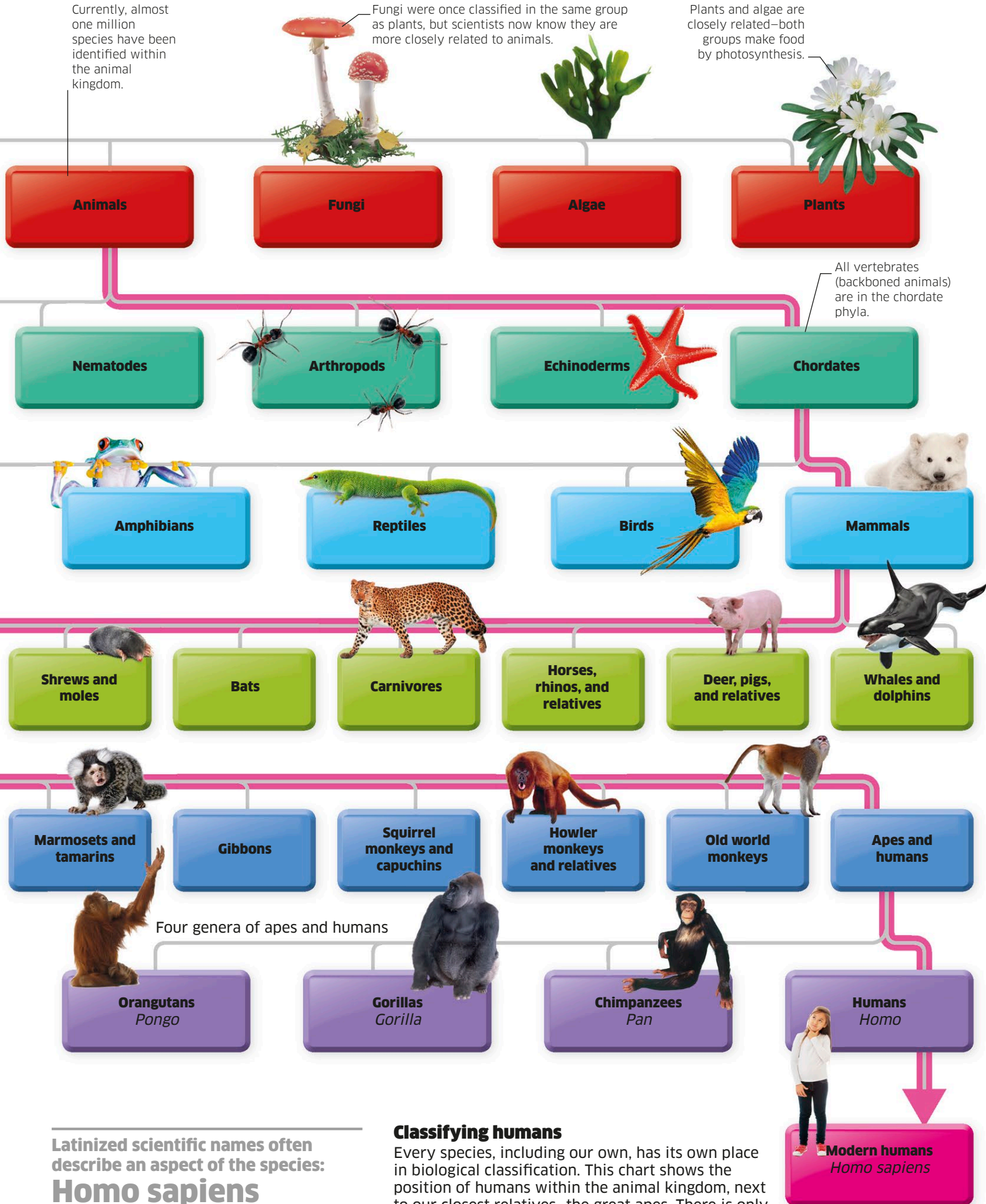


Currently, almost one million species have been identified within the animal kingdom.

Fungi were once classified in the same group as plants, but scientists now know they are more closely related to animals.

Plants and algae are closely related—both groups make food by photosynthesis.

Organisms are classified in a multilevel system of groups.



Latinized scientific names often describe an aspect of the species:
Homo sapiens
means “wise man.”

Classifying humans

Every species, including our own, has its own place in biological classification. This chart shows the position of humans within the animal kingdom, next to our closest relatives—the great apes. There is only one species of human alive today, but other species of the genus *Homo* lived in the prehistoric past.